Interview day sheet

Private prep · all numbers from the sent pack · scenario date Tue 20 Oct 2026

The clock (40 min, I keep time)

Clock	Block	Aim	Checkpoint line
0:00	Part 1: Triage & forecast (12)	finish talking by 9:30	"12 minutes on the book, 18 on Brightloop, 10 on automation. I'll keep us on time."
0:12	Part 2: Brightloop (18)	call 0:14 → 0:29	"That's 12 minutes, moving to Brightloop."
0:30	Part 3: Automation (10)	finish talking by 0:36	"That's 30 minutes, last part: automation."
0:40	Debrief (20, they lead)	-	"That's 40 minutes, over to you."

Behind? Cut detail, never a part. If the call runs over 15 min, close it yourself: "Let me summarise where we've landed."

Part 1 · Triage & forecast · 12 min

Min	Cover	Numbers
0–0:30	Time plan + date	Brief says December; I set **Tue 20 Oct** so one renewal is overdue and nine are within 60 days.
0:30–1:30	Headline	**€375k**, 10 renewals (Oct €69k · Nov €184k · Dec €122k). Weighted today **€133k**. By 30 Oct **€245k** with actions vs **€119k** without. **3 escalations, €116k**. GRR **92.9%**.
1:30–6:30	Ranking: slack × ARR at risk	see below
6:30–9:30	Forecast	see below
9:30–12	Their questions	see the Q&A table

"I'm escalating three today: Halden and Tessera on risk and size, and Vantage because it's overdue and we need a grace-period policy. That's €116k."

Ranking (in this order, one line each)

#	Account	ARR · days	The one line
1	Northwind	€48k · 9d	No quote. Quote out today at €48k, signature booked **27 Oct**. Signed 3 days late last year.
2	Vantage ⚑	€21k · −5d	CSM finds instance owners → I call a named person. **Escalate** grace period: exec contact day 14, formal notice day 30.
3	Pixelforge	€26k · 13d	Expired card = involuntary churn on a green account. Card link, Finance pauses dunning.
4	Halden ⚑	€45k · 18d	Red, usage −35%, champion gone. **Escalate** to manager + VP CS; Legal checks the **8 Oct** notice date.
5	Tessera ⚑	€50k · 29d	**Escalate** to Legal: response by **30 Oct**; security pack today; 1–2 month extension as fallback.
6	Brightloop	€36k · 55d	Part 2. Finance pre-approval up to 12% and net 60.
7	Marlowe	€46k · 50d	DPA + questionnaire (AI draft, Security reviews) with the quote; work back from PO lead time.
8	Kestrel	€35k · 39d	Usage +40%. One quote: renewal €35k + upsell on separate lines. Upside **+€10–15k**, not in forecast.
9	Lumen	€28k · 32d	Wrong legal entity; notice deadline **22 Oct** (assumed 30 days).
10	Quanta	€40k · 60d	Usage −20%, silent. New contact; 2-year lock or right-size before **~19 Nov** notice.

Process point (bridge to Part 3): **5 of 7** manual renewals have no quote inside 60 days.

Forecast

- **Method:** Renewal Status × days to renewal. Weighted = new ARR × probability.
- **Today €133k** = on time **€72k** (Lumen, Kestrel, Marlowe, Brightloop, Quanta) + late in Q4 **€61k** (Vantage, Northwind, Pixelforge, Halden, Tessera). Unweighted **€348.4k**. Slips past quarter: **€0**.
- **30 Oct:** €245k with actions (+€112k) vs €119k without (−€13.5k) → **€126k** difference. Northwind, Tessera, Kestrel, Marlowe = **€86k** of the gain.
- **Lost:** regrettable **−€23k** (Halden −€15k, Quanta −€8k) + concession **−€3.6k** (Brightloop yr 1) → €348.4k → **GRR = NRR = 92.9%**; NRR ~**96%** if Kestrel's upsell signs.
- **Least sure:** the lost number, driven by Halden (**€0–45k**). Quanta second (**−€40k**, not −€8k, if notice lands before ~19 Nov). Tessera on timing.

Part 1 · numbers questions they may ask

They ask	I answer
Why is €133k so low?	Early statuses in the quarter. The gap to €348.4k is risk, not loss. This week's actions take it to €245k.
€375k → €348.4k?	Halden −€15k, Quanta −€8k, Brightloop −€3.6k = −€26.6k.
Halden is 10%, but you only lose €15k?	10% is the chance it closes on time. −€15k is the contraction if it renews right-sized. That gap is exactly why it's my least-sure number.
What's your downside?	If Halden and Quanta both churn fully: €375k − €45k − €40k − €3.6k = **€286.4k, GRR 76.4%**. That's the case I'm escalating to prevent.
Why Northwind before Tessera (€50k)?	Slack: 9 days with no quote vs 29 days. One hour today removes most of Northwind's risk.
5 of 7 vs 1 of 7?	Both true: 2 were quoted, but Vantage's quote went out 44 days before, not 60.
Is the 5% uplift on top?	No. It's built into every renewal value (closed ARR × 1.05).
Northwind shows €45.6k on 30 Oct, not €48k?	Deliberately conservative (PO received, 95%). Once signed it's €48k.
How good is the probability matrix?	Not calibrated yet. I'd back-test it against last year's actual Q4 outcomes.
Commit vs best case?	Weighted €133k today, €245k if this week lands; ceiling €348.4k.

Part 2 · Brightloop · 18 min

Clock	Block	What I do
12–14	Plan to the panel (2)	Value first with the CSM → two structures, procurement chooses → walk-away.
14–15	Open (1)	Agenda, time, who decides and who signs.
15–18	Discovery, Sam (3)	Budget figure? **Cash or this year's cost?** Fiscal year? Why executions fell 10%?
18–21	Value + support (3)	CSM shows what n8n runs for them; I own the two slow escalations.
21–24	Options, Priya (3)	Both side by side; lead with the one discovery points to.
24–27	Trade (3)	"If… then…" only. Never split the difference.
27–29	Close (2)	Summary, owners, order-form date, signature by **30 Nov**.
29–30	Out of character (1)	Debrief line: "I moved the conversation from discount to structure."

The numbers

	Ramp (keep plan, annual)	Downsize + lock (upfront)
Price	Yr 1 **€32,400** (−10%) · Yr 2 **€35,910** (−5% on €37,800)	**€28,800**/yr, locked 2 or 3 yrs (plan assumed ~20% smaller)
Contract	**€68,310** ≈ 5% below 2 × €36,000	**€57,600** (2y) · **€86,400** (3y)
Concession	**7.4%** vs list path €73,800 → Finance	List price; waived uplift **2.4% / 4.8%**
Terms	Net 30 or 45	Net 60 (Finance)

- **Their ask:** €27,000 (25% off, needs VP). Over 2 years: €54,000 vs list path €73,800 = **€19,800** off; gap to my ramp = **€14,310**.

- **Walk-away:** no termination right, auto-renewal stays, max **12%** off current plan → 2-year total ≥ **€64,944**. Below that: downsize at list.
- **In reserve:** downgrade buffer up to **10%** of allowance from year 2 (VP pre-approved). Used in full = 12.3% below list: *it's a smaller plan, not a discount.*
- **Not 15%:** €3,600 + €1,890 = €5,490 ÷ €73,800 = **7.4%**.

Surprises

They say	I answer
"Our budget is €30k."	Downsize + lock fits (€28.8k). Full plan: a 12% year 1 = **€31,680** (8.4% total, within Finance).
"3 years for 25% off."	"That changes the picture. I'll take it to my VP and come back within 48 hours." No commitment.
"Competitor is 40% cheaper."	What's in scope? Migration and rebuild cost. I don't match; I offer the two options.
"We'll self-host the free version."	Real option: they lose SSO, environments, Git, log streaming, SLA support, plus DevOps cost.
"Net 60 is policy."	"Net 60 comes with upfront payment: the downsize + lock."
"Lock, but pay annually."	"The lock comes with upfront. Annually, the ramp gives this year's relief."
"All four or no deal."	"I can't do the exit clause or remove auto-renewal for anyone. What problem are they solving?"
Silence	Offers expire **30 Nov**; exec-to-exec on **1 Dec**.

Give → get: yr-1 relief → 2-yr term signed by 30 Nov · price lock → upfront · net 60 → upfront · top support tier → multi-year + support review · buffer → drop the termination ask · auto-renewal after term + 90-day reminder → clause stays.

Part 3 · Automation · 10 min

Clock	Cover	Numbers / key words
30–31	The problem	**221** renewals a quarter; in this book only **1 of 7** manual renewals was quoted by day 60.
31–33	Video	**78 seconds**. Say first: built **13 Oct**, before the case, on sample accounts.
33–36	How it works	Daily **8:00** · unsigned renewals within **90 days** · windows 30/60/90 · three routes: like-for-like, upsell, risk (alert, no email) · Gmail Approve/Reject · amounts from the sheet, never the model.
36–40	Measures + questions	Quote by day 60: **1/7 → 100%** · days from alert to send · signed before renewal date · drafts approved without edits.

What I'd add for this book: approved CPQ quote and order form attached · chase unsigned order forms on **days 3 and 7** · write the status back to the CRM. **Tie back:** it would have flagged the 5 missing quotes, Northwind included.

> Time saved isn't quantified in the pack. If asked, estimate out loud ("X minutes per renewal × 221 a quarter") and say it's an estimate to validate.

Debrief · 20 min (they lead)

- **Went well / improve:** pick 1–2 of each from `debrief_and_questions.md` after the session, based on what actually happened.
- **Time spent:** about **4 hours** vs the brief's 2. Say it plainly; AI let me go further.
- **Feedback:** thank, repeat the development area in one sentence, "next time I'd…". Don't defend.
- **Questions:** CSM ↔ Renewals handoff · current forecast accuracy (commit / best case) · systems (CRM, CPQ, billing; n8n internally?) · first 90 days success.

Wording traps (pack says it two ways)

- **Escalations:** 3, €116k (Halden, Tessera, Vantage). The summary page names only two.
- **Least sure:** Halden = the lost number. Same answer.
- **Quotes:** 5 of 7 not quoted · 1 of 7 quoted on time. Both true.